

Dogus Aktan

Rice University
Political Science Department
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Current Status	Lecturer, Department of Political Science, Rice University
Research Interests	Contentious Politics, Social Movements, State Repression, Civil Resistance, Formal Models, Agent-Based Modeling
Teaching Interests	International Relations, Comparative Politics, International Political Economy, International Security, Civil Wars and Political Violence, Social Movements, Authoritarian Politics, Research Design and Quantitative Methods, Game Theory and Simulation
Academic Appointments	Rice University Lecturer, Department of Political Science, 2024–present University of Kentucky Teaching Postdoctoral Scholar, Department of Political Science, 2023–2024 Josef Korbel School of International Studies, University of Denver Adjunct Professor, 2018–2023
Education	2023 Ph.D. in International Studies, Josef Korbel School of International Studies, University of Denver <i>Examination Fields:</i> International Relations, Comparative Politics 2016 M.A. in International Studies, Josef Korbel School of International Studies, University of Denver 2013 B.A. in Political Science, Galatasaray University
Peer-Reviewed Publications	Aktan, Dogus. “How Does Violence Deter? Functional and Informational Effects of Preemptive Repression.” <i>Journal of Peace Research</i> . 2025.
Working Papers	Aktan, Dogus. “Repression as a screening tool: Strategic Restraint and the Punishment Puzzle” <i>Under Review</i> . Aktan, Dogus. “Ignoring or Responding to Protests.”

Updated June 2026.

Teaching Experience

Rice University

Protest, Resistance, and Government Response. Spring 2026, Fall 2026

Applied Econometrics for Policy Analysis. Fall 2025

Protests and Political Violence (Senior Seminar). Spring 2025

Introduction to International Relations. Spring 2025, Spring 2026, Fall 2026

Introduction to Comparative Politics. Fall 2024, Fall 2025

Applied Research Methods. Fall 2024, Spring 2025, Fall 2025, Spring 2026, Fall 2026

University of Kentucky

International Organizations. Fall 2023, Spring 2024

Dynamics of International Law. Spring 2024

Honors Thesis in Political Science. Fall 2023

Conduct of American Foreign Relations. Fall 2023

International Political Economy. Spring 2024

University of Denver

Globalization and Knowledge Economy. Fall 2021, Winter 2021, Spring 2022, Fall 2022, Winter 2022, Spring 2023

Major Issues in International Security. Winter 2020

Contemporary Issues in Political Economy. Fall 2018, Winter 2018, Spring 2019, Winter 2019

Dragons, Mutants, and Drug Dealers: Advanced Topics in IR and IPE through Western Pop Culture. Fall 2019

Workshops

Math Workshop for Graduate Students, Josef Korbel School of International Studies, University of Denver

Causal Inference (DAGs) Workshop for Graduate Students, Josef Korbel School of International Studies, University of Denver

Teaching Assistant

Contemporary Issues in Political Economy (Undergraduate), with Dr. Keith Gehring. Fall 2016 – Spring 2018

International Politics (Graduate), with Dr. Jack Donnelly. Fall 2017, Winter 2017

Research Assistant

Graduate Research Assistant for Dr. Joseph Szyliowicz. September 2014–June 2016

Graduate Research Assistant for Dr. Erica Chenoweth, Major Episodes of Contention (MEC) Project. September 2015–September 2017

**Additional
Training**

ICPSR Summer Program, 2018:
Mathematical Models: Rational Choice Theories of Politics and Society
Game Theory
Social Choice
Empirical Implications of Theoretical Models (EITM) Summer Institute, 2019
Bridging the Gap New Era Workshop (NEW), 2021
Responsible Engagement Initiative Pre-Peace Science Workshop (RPEI), 2022
Introduction to Agent-Based Modeling, Santa Fe Institute, 2022
Peace Science Rising Scholars Workshop, 2022

**Fellowships
& Grants**

United States Institute of Peace (USIP) Peace Scholar Fellowship, 2020
Empirical Implications of Theoretical Models (EITM) Summer Institute Fellowship, 2019
Josef Korbel School of International Studies, Methods Workshop Grant for ICPSR, 2018 (\$3,000)
Josef Korbel School of International Studies, Conference Travel Grant, 2019–2020 (\$4,000)

Service

Rice University

Summer Undergraduate Research Fellowships Mentor, Summer 2026
Social Policy Analysis Policy Challenge Judge, Fall 2025
Social Sciences Research and Creative Symposium Judge, Spring 2025
Social Policy Analysis (SOPA) Faculty Advisory Committee, 2025–2026
Social Sciences Divisional Advisor for McMurtry College, Fall 2024–present

Discipline

Grant Review for the Minerva Project and Peace Scholars, United States Institute of Peace, 2025
Peer Review for *Journal of Peace Research* and *American Political Science Review*
AP Comparative Government and Politics Visiting Fellow, 2025
Graduate Assistant to Program Chairs, ISA Annual Conference, 2022
Graduate Assistant to Program Chairs, ISSS-IS Annual Conference, 2019

Languages

Turkish (native), English (fluent), German (fluent), French (fluent)

**Relevant
Skills**

Mathematica, L^AT_EX, NetLogo, Causal Inference, DAGs